

My Camp180 Journal - Python 2D Game Dev

A printable coding journal to track your progress, reflect on your learning, and grow as a creative coder.

About This Journal

Welcome, coder! This journal is your **coding sidekick** for the Camp180 Python 2D Game Dev course. Use it to:

- Reflect on what you've learned
- Track your projects and progress
- Jot down new ideas, bugs, and victories
- Set goals and celebrate milestones

You can print this or fill it in digitally.

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Week 1: Setup & Orientation

What did you install this week?

- [] Python
- [] VS Code
- [] Git
- [] Pygame
- [] GitHub account created

Journal Prompt:

> What was the easiest part of setting up your environment? What tripped you up?

Notes:

Dev Tip:

> The best debugger is a good night's sleep.

Week 2–4: Python Basics**Skills I practiced:**

- [] Variables & Data Types
- [] If/else conditionals
- [] Loops (for, while)
- [] Writing simple programs

Mini Project Notes:

What was your favorite mini project or challenge?

What would you do differently if you had to debug it again? _____

Quote:

> “Programs must be written for people to read, and only incidentally for machines to execute.” – Harold Abelson

Week 5–6: Functions & Lists**Things to reflect on:**

- What is the difference between a parameter and an argument? _____
-

- Can you reuse code more effectively now? _____
-

- What's a bug you had that taught you something? _____
-

Bonus Space: Battle Simulator Planning Function ideas: - attack()_____

- defend()_____

- enemy_turn()_____

Week 7–10: VS Code + Turtle Graphics

What's your favorite VS Code extension so far? _____

What did you draw using `turtle`? Share or sketch below!

Sketch Space:

Dev Tip:

> “Coding is like solving puzzles with infinite retries.”

Week 11–15: Pygame & First Game

Things I learned about Pygame:

- [] How to create a game window
- [] How to move sprites
- [] How to handle keyboard input

Game idea brainstorm:

- Game Name: _____
- Main Character: _____
- Goal: _____
- Obstacles: _____

Final Project Planning (Weeks 23–26)

Use this section to outline your **final game**:

- Title: _____
- Genre: _____
- What makes it fun? _____
- Who would play it? _____

Design Checklist:

- ☐ Map/sketch of levels
- ☐ Player/sprite design
- ☐ Sound effects/music
- ☐ Start screen, game over screen

My GitHub Progress

Track your uploads and commits:

Week	Commit Message	Link
1	Initial commit	
2	Added calculator project	
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Final Reflection

- What are you most proud of? _____
- What advice would you give to someone starting out? _____
- How has your thinking changed about coding? _____

Quote:

> “You don’t have to be great to start, but you have to start to be great.” – Zig Ziglar

About Camp180

Every game you build helps sponsor a student at Camp180 Coding Camps. Thank you for being part of something bigger.

“Code with purpose. Create with passion.”